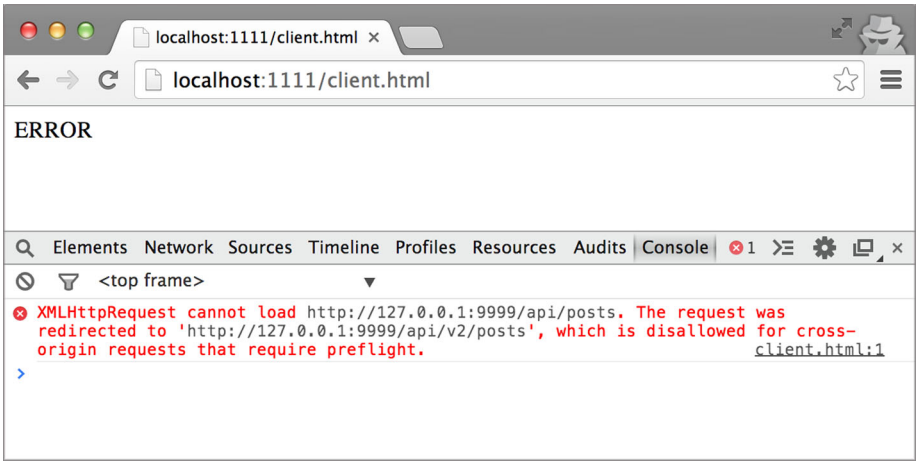


Figure 6.17 Error when redirecting a request with a preflight

the request will fail. Figure 6.17 shows the error message you'll see in Chrome if you try to redirect a request that requires a preflight.

In this case, you'll need to manually inspect the response's Location header to figure out where the server is trying to redirect you, then send your request directly to that URL.

Here is a recap of how CORS works with redirects:

- Simple CORS requests will follow redirects.
- Preflight requests will not follow redirects.
- If the redirect is to the same server as the original request, the Origin header will stay the same. Otherwise, the Origin header will be set to `null`.

You probably won't run into redirects often, but it's still useful to understand how they work so you can build your API appropriately.

6.9 Summary

This chapter opened with questions you should ask yourself about your own CORS needs. After answering those questions, you should have a better idea of how you want to configure your server. The chapter then took a closer look at how to configure the various CORS-specific headers for your own needs. Here is a recap of each header:

- Access-Control-Allow-Origin:
  - Use the `*` value to allow requests from all origins.
  - Use a whitelist to allow only certain origins.
- Access-Control-Allow-Credentials:
  - Setting the value to `true` allows cookies on requests.
  - Enable cookies only if you're sure you need them.
  - If your server does support cookies, be sure to also validate the origin and implement CSRF protection.